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Brakes put on fuel economy standards

Relaxed rules curb targets meant to cut vehicles' pollution

By **Alexa St. John** and **Anne D'Innocenzio**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DETROIT — The Trump administration on Monday released new fuel economy standards that relax regulatory requirements for auto-

makers to control pollution from gasoline-powered cars and light trucks. The new rules were released shortly after President Donald Trump rejected an Iranian proposal to open the Strait of Hormuz, sending oil prices soaring.

The change furthers Trump's promise to revoke policies that encouraged or created incentives for the production of electric vehicles and ultimately, will expose Americans to more planet-warm-

ing pollution from vehicles.

Mileage standards, known as Corporate Average Fuel Economy, or CAFE, requirements, have been implemented since the 1970s energy crisis, and set out how far new vehicles need to travel on a gallon of gasoline. Over time, automakers have gradually improved their vehicles' average efficiency.

The Department of Transportation and the National Highway Traffic Safety Administration estimated

that the finalized standards would correspond to a combined industry fleetwide average of roughly 34.9 miles per gallon for passenger cars and light trucks in the 2031 model year. That's up from 30.1 miles per gallon for model year 2024, but down from a projected 50.4 miles per gallon in 2031 under rules put in place by the Biden administration.

"Thanks to President Trump's leadership, we have finally ended the illegal mandate that forced auto-

makers to produce more expensive electric vehicles that American families didn't want," Secretary of Transportation Sean Duffy said in a statement touting vehicle affordability.

NHTSA had projected last December that the new standards would hover at roughly 34.5 miles per gallon.

News of the revised standards

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Council majority opposes head tax

Letter warns Johnson about pursuing it in the 2027 city budget

By **Alice Yin**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A majority of City Council members came out Monday in opposition to Mayor Brandon Johnson potentially taking another go at a corporate employee head tax in the upcoming 2027 budget.

The letter, signed by 29 aldermen, is an early attempt by Johnson's council opposition to stake out its territory ahead of the mayor's fourth budget address next month.

Johnson has not confirmed what he will propose in his spending plan for next year to close a projected \$882 million gap, but progressive allies have clamored for another try at the employee head tax despite his failed attempt to pass one as part of this year's budget.

Now, the 29 aldermen are sending him a warning to give up on that idea.

"A great city should court employers, not punish them for the act of putting people to work," the letter says. "We will not support a head tax, or any levy that makes it costlier to keep and create jobs for Chicagoans."

In a response Monday afternoon, Johnson's press secretary Allison Novelo implored aldermen "to come to the table not only with a list of what they will not support, but with concrete solutions for closing the projected deficit."

"From day one, this administration has been clear that we will not balance the budget on the backs of working people or by cutting critical services Chicagoans rely on," Novelo wrote. "We welcome all ideas, but they need to be grounded in revenues and savings that can be realized."

Progressive Caucus members Ald. Desmon Yancy and Ronnie Mosley were among the signees, as was Johnson's Finance chair Ald. Pat Dowell. Twenty-nine is not veto-proof, however, and the demands rehash many of the same disagreements between Johnson and City Council in the 2026 budget that has had a rough implementation.

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White Sox fans cheer on their team in the eighth inning against the Twins at Rate Field in Chicago on Sept. 5. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

A season of faith's perfection



For long-suffering White Sox fans, there's catharsis and redemption in unexpected postseason run

By **Andrew Carter**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Toward the end of the White Sox's long and tortured 2024 season, Jerry Meyer, a lifelong supporter and survivor of much Sox-inflicted trauma, wondered if perhaps he missed some sort of announcement. He showed up early to Rate Field, as he often does, to an eerie scene of desolation.

It felt a little like the aftermath of the apocalypse. Or like an abandoned town from an old Western. Even the often-festive Lot B, where the heartiest of Sox diehards gather, was dead, and Meyer thought maybe the game had been postponed or that he had the wrong time.

He can laugh about it now, and he did on Sunday in the hours before the White Sox's regular season finale. He and his close friend, Henry Radke, had fired

INSIDE
Sox, Cubs prepare to begin postseason play today. **Sports**

up the grill and cracked open a beer or two, and it felt good to be a Sox fan again. All around Lot B, where Radke parked his truck — "4 DA SOX," his license plate read — it felt like a mass catharsis, and the end of a marathon.

Sox supporters had made it. They'd persevered through three consecutive 100-loss seasons. Through the historic — not so much in a good way — 121 defeats of two years ago. Through the punchlines and flatlines of seasons that felt over before they began. They'd made it through everything to reach Sunday, and the emptiness of recent Septembers gave way to perfection: It was 70 degrees, sunny and cloudless, and the

See **SOX** on Page A4

Brothers Tom and Mike Karpinski smoke cigars while tailgating before the last regular season White Sox game of the year on Sunday against the Rockies at Rate Field. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/TRIBUNE**

Chicago River bridge lifts set to begin

Starting Wednesday, bridges along the Chicago River will lift almost a dozen times this fall to allow recreational vessels to return to winter storage yards. **Business**

British men in air base case make bail

Five men arrested on explosives and terror charges near a U.S.-operated base in England were released on bail, and detectives were investigating the possibility of a link to Iran. **Nation & World**

About 9,300 immigrants in Illinois to lose Medicaid

Coverage to end this week for many because of Big Beautiful Bill

By **Lisa Schencker**
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Teresita V. Morales was in for a shock when she read a letter delivered to her longtime partner recently.

It was a letter from the state informing him that he would no longer qualify for Medicaid cover-

age after Sept. 30 because of a new federal law that changes which types of immigrants are eligible for the program.

Morales' partner, Eugén Cuña, who is originally from Romania, suffered a devastating stroke more than 15 years ago that left him partially paralyzed and unable to speak, she said. He has lived in nursing homes ever since. The couple relies on Medicaid to pay for that round-the-clock care.

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Teresita V. Morales' partner, Eugén Cuña, has lived in nursing homes for the past 16 years after suffering a stroke. Cuña, pictured on Monday, recently received a letter from the state saying that he will lose Medicaid coverage. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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